7.4.1 Factors Affecting a Cuisine

- A cuisine is frequently named after the region or place where it is originated.
- It is primarily influenced by the locally available ingredients, the religion and the culture.
- The area's climate determines the native foods that are available.
- The trade among different countries also largely affects a region's cuisine.



▲ Plate 7.9 Cuisines

7.4.2 Common Cuisines

The common cuisines are Indian, International and fusion cuisine.

I. Indian Cuisine: Indian cuisines are as diversified and unique as its culture and country encompasses a wide variety of regional and traditional cuisines. Indian food is often thought of as an 'exotic cuisine' with charm of its own, it has such a great variety of taste, colour and aroma.

II. Regional Cuisine: It is based upon national, state or local regions. Regional cuisines may vary based upon food availability and trade, varying climates, cooking traditions and practices and cultural differences. Each state has evolved its very own cuisine influenced by the availability of certain raw foods of the region. The cooking style varies from region to region and it is largely divided into South Indian and North Indian cuisine.

Characteristic Features

- Indian cuisine gives the range of diversity in soil type, climate, culture, ethnic group and occupations.
- The staple food varies with region to region. In the southern part of India, rice is the staple food while in the northern part it is wheat.
- There are special foods prepared for occasions like festival in all the regions.
- Indian cuisines use locally available spices, herbs, vegetables and fruits.
- A three meal balanced diet pattern is the most common feature in Indian cuisine.

1. North Indian Cuisine: North India has extreme climates – summer is hot and winter is cold. To quote a few, the region includes the following states: Jammu and Kashmir, Himachal Pradesh, Punjab, Maharashtra, Madhya Pradesh.



▲ Plate 7.10 Indian Cuisine

FSM_Theory_ch7.indd 94 20-02-2019 5.59.27 PM